

Tarh for the First Sunday of the Lent

طرح الأحد الأول من الصوم الكبير

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ملخص:

هذا المقال ينشر ورقتين من مخطوطة بباريس ١٤٦ قبطي، وسوف نقدم وصفًا للمخطوطة على ما جاء في كتالوج دولابورت. وفي هذا البحث نستكمل ما قد بدأه العالم الراحل أوزولد بورمستر منذ ما يقرب من ثلاثة أرباع القرن. ولم تظهر دراسات كثيرة في هذا الموضوع. وقد لفت نظري في هذا المخطوط أنه يتميز عن النص المطبوع بأنه يعكس تقليدًا محليًا غير معروف. والناسخ من مصر السفلى ولكنه يعيش في مصر العليا. وقد نُشر النص القبطي والنص العربي في المخطوط، وهو ما يظهر أن النص العربي أطول كثيرًا من النص القبطي. وقد نشرنا النص الحالي الموجود في كتاب منشور.

Introduction

Tarh is a liturgical text which has a commentary on the Scriptures or life of a saint that had been read previously.¹ In his monumental study on the Coptic O.H.E. Burmester highlights the use of the Turuhāt in the Coptic Church especially during Lent.² His study was mainly based on Coptic books printed in Egypt. These books have only the first two stanzas in Coptic and the whole text in Arabic reflecting a late tradition of the Copto-Arabic Manuscripts.³ The importance of the Turuhāt lies in that they are used in nearly all the services of the Coptic Church.⁴ Since the work of Burmester, very few studies had been done on the subject.⁵

The aim of this article is to publish and edit a text that escapes notice of the scholarly world.

Manuscripts

We will give in full the description of the catalogue of Delaporte⁶

Hymnes (bohairique)

1-17 v *Tarh* pour les dimanches de Carême. 18r-166v Groupes de deux hymnes, l'une dans le ton baouos, et l'autre dans le ton adam, pour les fêtes de la Nativité, la circoncision, le Baptême du Christ, Théodore l'Oriental, Philothée, Antoine, Souriel, Paul l'ermite, les quarante-neuf martyrs, Macaire le Grand, Gabriel, Raphael, Barsomam, Jean-Baptiste, Victor, Marc l'évangéliste, les trois jeunes gens, Pachôme, la Vierge à Philippe, Schenouti, les apôtres, l'annonciation, les patriarches Abraham, Isaac et Jacob, etc.

Ms de 166 feuillets ; 20x15. Texte : 15x11 ; 13 lignes de 19 à 18 lettres sans date.

Ce manuscrit n'est pas coté en Copte. Il y a des lacunes après les feuillets 17,

18, 20, 71, 107, 130, 132, 150, 164 et 165 ; 166 n'est pas le dernier du texte primitif.

Titres arabes en lettre rouges. Chaque hymne est suivie d'une pièce arabe. Majuscules à la marge, noires et rouges, f, ; et à portent un point rouge dans la boucle.

Invent. Copte 146

In fact the manuscript is more than one bound together. After the Turuhāt of the Lent we find the following Colophon:

وكان الفراغ منه يوم السبت المبارك خامس عشر شهر توت
المبارك في سنة ٨٧٢ للهـ للشهدا الأطهار السعداء الأبرار رزقنا
الله تعالى ببركاتهم آمين وذلك

مما اهتم بذلك الطرح من تعب الشماس المكرم المعلم هندي
ابن المنتح ميخائيل المنشاوي وأوقفه على خزانة الكتب
بدير القديس العظيم الجليل* في القديسين ملح الارض أبي
القديس أبوسيفين وكل من اخرج من الدير المذكور بوجه
من وجوه التلاف أو بيع أو سرقة أو يخرج بطريق التعدي
يكون نصيبه مع سيمون الساحر ويهوذا الإسخريوطي الذي
أسلم سيده ويكون مدان من الرب سبحانه وتعالى ولا يكون
له غفران أبدا ولربنا المجد إلى الأبد آمين

والناسخ المسكين بخطاياهم المقر بأثامه الذي لم يستحق ان
اسمه بالجملة من كثرة خطاياهم وغلطاتهم وزلاتهم وسقطاتهم وقبح
افعاله الردية بالاسم رافيل شماس لا بالعمل ابن غبريال بن
عبد السيد المعروف بابن نصر الله الحشني بناحية شبين القناطر
يومئذ بدير القديس العظيم الجليل في القديسين المجد في
الطوباوين الاب البار والثناء المختار الاب الفاضل القديس
العظيم إيشاي المكنى ببطرس المعروف بجبل أدريه بوادي
الصعيد بوادي جرجا فهو يسال ويتضرع ويظرب عدة من
المطانة تحت اقدام السادة الواقفين عليه ان يصفحوا عن الله
وغلطاتهم ويتجاوزوا عن هفواته فإنه جسر وتقلد وكتب بما
لا يعلم وهو قليل الخبرة بالألفاظ المستقيمة وهو يسال قدس
الإخوة أن يتجاوزوا عن هفواته ويزدوهم إلى معاني الخير
ويدعوا له ولوالدته بغفران الخطايا والذنوب من قبل الله تعالى
يا قاري الخط بالعين تنظر هو لا تنس كاتب ال [ير تذكر هو
اوهب له دعوتنا لله خالص

The accomplishment of this was on the blessed Saturday the 15th of the blessed

Tût in the year 1362 of the pure happy righteous martyrs may the sublime God grant us their blessings (1646AD) Amen.

That who cares about this Tarh from his own pains the honoured deacon the master Hindî son of the reposed Michael al-Minshawî and he endowed it to the library (the book-case) of the monastery⁷ of the great honoured saint among* the saints, the salt of earth, my father, saint Abû Sayfin⁸ (who has two swords = Mercurius) and whoever took it out of the abovementioned monastery for any damaging reason or by selling, or by stealing or by any transgressing, let his share be with Simon the magician and Judas the Iscariot who delivered his Lord. Let him be condemned from the sublime Lord, let Him be praised. He should never have forgiveness. Glory be to our Lord for ever Amen!

The poor scribe, who confesses his transgressions, who is not at all worthy his name because of the multitude of his sins, his faults, his lapses, his falls and his bad evil acts, by name Raphael

deacon not by (his own) deeds son of Gabriel son of Abd al-Sayid known as Ibn Nasrallah the Ethiopian (al-Habashî) from the district of Shibîn al-Qanatir and he was at this day in the monastery of the great honoured saint among the honoured saints, the blessed among the blessed men, the righteous father and the chosen pot, the just great saint Bishay nicknamed Peter (Butrus) known in the mountain of Adrib in the valley of Upper-Egypt in the valley of Girgâ. He demands, beseeches and prostrates under their feet, who read⁹ to forgive his lapses and his faults and to pardon his errors for he dared to imitate and to write what he did not know and he has not experience of the right language. He asked the holiness of the brethren to overpass his lapses and to add to the good meanings. (He asked them) to pray for him and his mother of the forgiveness of sins and transgressions. O reader of this handwriting, by your eye, do not forget the scribe [] remember that he gives to God

Coptic text	Translation from Coptic	Arabic text	Translation from Arabic
CYN ΘΕΩ CWTEN EPIPECTCROW `MMHI  `NTACKALITHC¹⁰ EΘΟΥAB OYOR ΦPECT `NHHΓAΘON  ZEN NICBOYI  `NTE PΩC ΦNHV `NHHETWENHNT  AC[MOY]T  `NHHPECTEPH[ORI] ECHOYH ETNATAHOIA¹¹ ZEN OYTOYBO NEM OYHEΘMI XE HAZΘETEN¹² ENETENTAI O EYEWPI EΘHANECT¹³ NEM OY2BHOCI¹⁴ `NACIKON NEM  OYTPAZIC `NΔIKEON `NHEPACI `NΔOPC EBOA OYΔE¹⁵ `NHEMΘO `NPOHI AN HNETE `NMON  KAT EPWOC  EYET[EI] ZEN  OYNETEΦANOY  [E]WPI  AKWANEPIHCTEIN  IA PEKZO W  ΠΑΜΕΠΙΤ ΘΩ2  `NTEKAFE ZEN OYNE2 OYOR WPI ZEN OYTOYBO TWP2 `NΠΔC OYOR MATZO  WY `NΠAIPH `NHEPMΘO  ZEN OY2HT  `NKAΘAPOC NEM OYCYNHΔECIC¹⁶ `MMHI XE PENIOT  ETZEN NIFHOYI  HAPETTOYBO `NXE PEKPAN HAPEC`I NXE TEKMETOYPO XE ΦOK PE ΠIWOY WΔ ENET2	<i>With God</i> Listen to the true teacher, the holy <i>master</i> and the Giver of goods through the teaching of His mouth, Lord of mercies, called the sinners to the <i>repentance</i> in purity and righteousness: 'Pay heed to your gifts (that) are profitable, the <i>rational</i> deeds and the <i>righteous acts</i> (saying) do not reveal them in front of the people who do not have intelligence so that they (good deeds) will fall in vanity. If you fast, (O) beloved, wash your face, anoint your head with oil¹⁷ be in purity. Pray to the Lord and beseech (Him) cry out thus in front of Him with a pure heart and true <i>conscience</i>: Our Father who are in Heavens, Hallowed be Your name, Your kingdom come for to You is the glory forever'	طرح واطس يقال في الاحد الاول من الصوم المقدس واطس التفسير: اسمعوا المعلم الحقيقي واضع التعاليم الطاهرة والأمر بالصالحات بتعاليم فيه المقدسة اب كل الآفات¹⁸ يدعو الخطاة الى التوبة والطهارة والعفاف قال تاملوا إلى كراماتكم وحسناتكم وأعمالكم البارة لا يظهروها قدام الناس الذين لا فهم لهم فتصير باطل ولا تصنعوها أمام الناظرين لكن اذا صمت يا حبيب اغسل وجهك وادهن راسك ويكون صومك في سر واطلب من الرب [] اصرخ هكذا قدماه بقلب نقي وضمير مستقيم وقل أبانا الذي في السموات يتقدس اسمك تاتي ملكوتك لك المجد إلى الأبد اعطنا بهجة خلاصك واغفر لنا خطايانا اثامنا كما نغفر لمن عليه واسمعنا وارحمنا يا صالح ومحب البشر ولا تدخلنا التجارب لكن نجنا من الشرير واعطنا يارب دعة لكيما نصوم صوم نقيا ونبكي قدماك من أجل خطايانا واغفر لنا يا مخلصنا واشفق علينا يا سيدنا واصنع معنا رحمة لاننا¹⁹ نحن شعبك وغنم رعيتك لك المجد إلى أبد الأبدين آمين	Tarh Watos to be said for the first Sunday of the holy Lent Watos Listen to the true teacher, the holy teaching establisher and who commands good things, the father of all mercies, in the holy teaching of His mouth, Lord of all mercies called the sinners to the repentance in purity and chastity, He said: 'Look to your honour, your alms and your good deeds to be revealed in front of the people who do not have intelligence, do not blame them in front of the beholders, but if you fast, o beloved, wash your face, anoint your head with oil²⁰ let your fast be in secret. Pray to the Lord and cry out in front of Him with a pure heart and straight conscience and say: 'Our Father who is in heaven, Hallowed be Your name. Your kingdom come. For to You is the kingdom forever.²¹ Grant us the joy of Your salvation.²² Forgive us for our sins and trespasses as we forgive our debtors²³ Hear us and have mercy upon us, O Good and lover of the humankind. Do not lead us into temptation, but deliver us from evil. Grant us Lord humility in order to fast a pure fasting and to weep in front of You because of our sins. Forgive us, O our Saviour. Have spared, O our Master. Have mercy upon us for we are Your people and the sheep of Your folk for to You is the Glory forever and ever Amen!

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up for yourselves treasures upon earth for these plunder the minds to the earthly affairs. For the treasures of this world are plundered by thieves, rifled by the robbers and looted by kidnappers, but lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven where neither thieves nor kidnappers nor robbers can draw near to them (the treasures). For where your treasures are there will be your heart and you became one with Christ in His kingdom. Hate the arrogant eyes and leave out the beastly hearts, seek for the heavenly food and the precious garments. Preserve your bodies from calumny let them be blessed because they are the altars of the Lord. Guard yourselves from carnal mixing for this is the first snare that hunts man. Behold the fowls of sky and how God feed them. Cast your burden upon Him and He shall sustain you in the same way.³⁵ And you cannot add to your stature one arm and you cannot make one hair white or black. Look to the fruitful plant and lilies of the fields that even Solomon in all his glory does not wear like one of these. Listen my beloved and consider deeds. Rely on His mercy and seek for the deliverance and these things shall be added to you. So who is God save our God. And who is Lord except Him. God grant us Your grace and abandon upon us Your peace. Take off our sins and have mercy upon us according to Your great mercy.

Conclusion

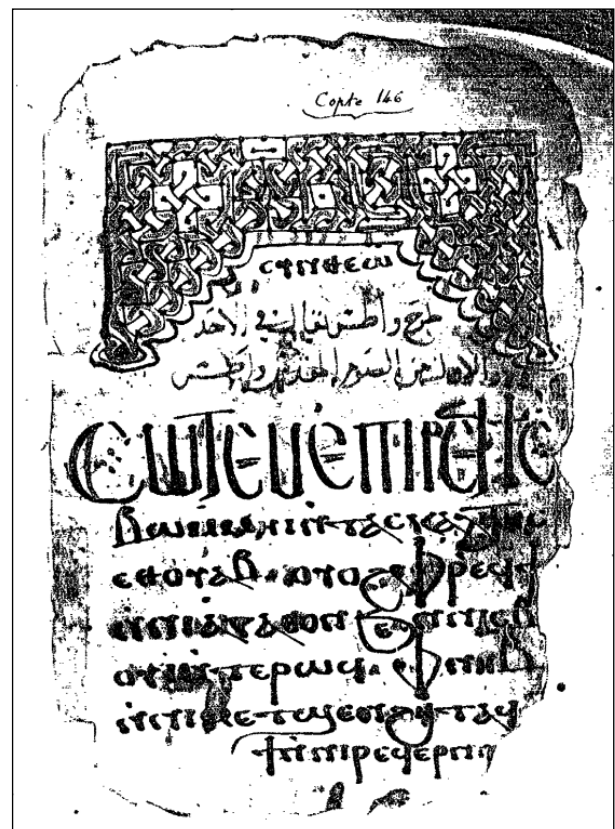
We discussed the relation between the lectionary and the Turûhât showing as G. Viaud, some forty years earlier shrewdly noticed:

« La liturgie Copte est riche à l'intérieur d'un certain « non fixisme ». Une

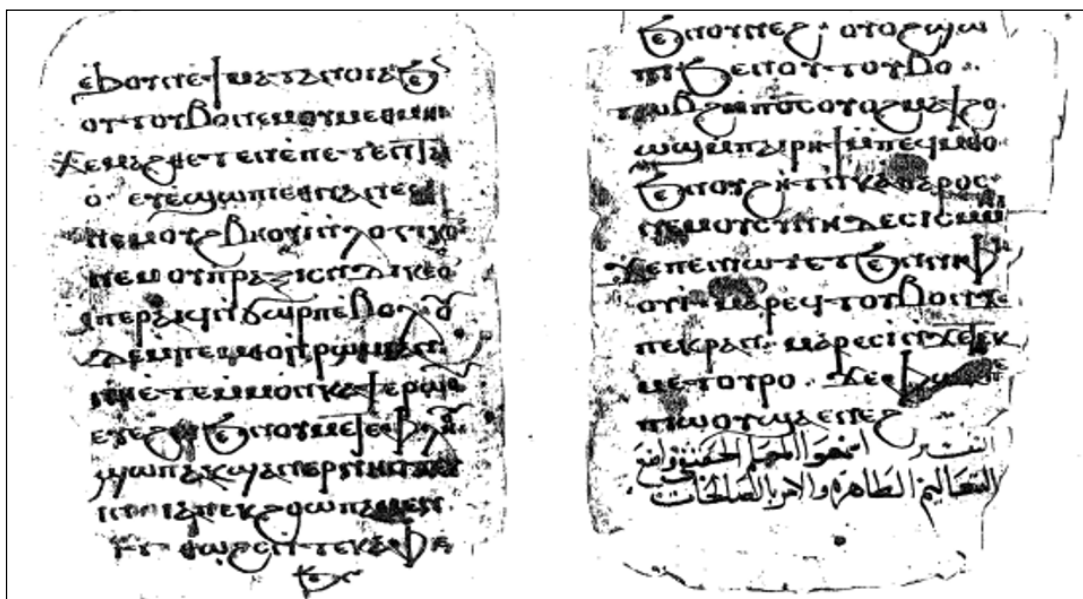
empreinte de liberté, dans un cadre bien déterminé, permet à la liturgie Copte de s'accommoder des lieux où elle se célèbre ainsi elle laisse éclore des formes variées dont le contenu est stable, laissant passer le même message, transmettant le même mystère ».³⁶

As U. Zanetti quoted regarding the liturgy of the White Monastery: 'even the simplest questions concerning the liturgy do not meet a satisfactory answer.'³⁷ Hence any publication contributes to our liturgical knowledge.

The liturgy was performed in Greek or Coptic and later translated into Arabic. This process did not attract the attention of the scholarly world. We prefer to provide the Coptic text with the original Arabic render.



(Fig. 1) Paris Copte 146 fol. 1r.



(Fig. 2) Paris Copte 146 fol. 1v-2r.



(Fig. 3) Paris Copte 146 fol. 2v.

Notes

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1. G. Viaud, *La liturgie des Coptes d'Égypte* (Paris, 1978), 109.
2. O.H.E. Burmester, 'The Turuhāt of the Coptic Year', *Orientalia Christiana Periodica* 3 (1937), 505-549 especially 507-512.
3. H.N. Takla, 'Copto (Bohairic)-Arabic manuscripts: Their role in the tradition of the Coptic Church', in: M. Immerzeel and J. van der Vliet (eds.), *Coptic Studies on the Threshold of a New Millennium-Proceeding of the Seventh International Congress of Coptic Studies, Leiden 27 August-2 September 2000* (Leuven, 2004), 639-646.
4. O.H.E. Burmester, *The Egyptian or Coptic Church Detailed Description of her Liturgical Services and Rites*,

- Textes et documents (Cairo, 1967), 110, 218, 256, 265, 276, 283, 284, 285, 292, 300.
5. J. Muysier, 'Le Psali copte pour la première heure du Samedi de la joie', *Le Muséon* 60 (1952), 175-184; M. Cramer, 'Studien zu koptischen Pascha-Büchern', *Oriens Christianus* 49 (1965), 90-115
 6. L. Delaporte, *Catalogue sommaire des manuscrits Coptes de la Bibliothèque Nationale de Paris* (Première Partie Manuscrits Bohairiques) (Paris, 1912), 81 N° 97.
 7. The place of this monastery is not mentioned. The Coptic Encyclopedia has three entries for the Dayr Abu Sayfayn cf. Ch. Coquin, 'Dayr Abu Sayfayn (Old Cairo)', R.G. Coquin & M. Martin, 'Dayr Abu Sayfayn (Qus)', R.G. Coquin & M. Martin, 'Dayr Abu Sayfayn Tamwayh', *Coptic Encyclopedia*, Vol.3 (New York, 1991), 710-712.
 8. For the title of the father of two swords cf. K.H. Brune, 'Vom St. Mercurios zum Abu Saifain zur Ikonographischen Wandlung eines Heiligen', *Bulletin de la Société d'Archéologie Copte* 34 (1995), 15-20.
 9. Lit 'who stand up on this'.
 10. Read ΔΙΔΑΚΚΑΛΟC based on Arabic render.
 11. Read ΠΙΕΤΑΝΟΙΑ.
 12. Read ΜΑΖΘΗΤΕΝ.
 13. Read ΕΘΗΑΝΕΥ.
 14. Read ΠΙΖΒΗΟΥ.
 15. Omit.
 16. Read CΥΠΕΙΛΟC.
 17. Mt 6:17.
 18. The scribe wrote first the word in singular الرأفة and later changed his mind and corrected into plural الرافات.
 19. Read لاتنا.
 20. Mt 6:17.
 21. Mt 6: 9-10.
 22. Ps. 50 [51]: 14.
 23. Mt 6:12.
 24. U. Zanetti, 'Les lectionnaires Coptes annuels Basse-Égypte', *Publications de l'Institut Orientaliste de Louvain* 33 (Louvain-La-Neuve, 1985), 9-14.
 25. A. Pietersma and S.T. Comstock, 'A Sahidic lectionary of the New Testament and the Psalms', *Bulletin of the American Society of Papyrologists* 29 (1992), 57-66; U. Zanetti, 'Abû-l-Barakât et les lectionnaires de Haute-Égypte', *Actes du IV congrès copte* (Louvain-La-Neuve, 1988); M. Rassart-Debergh and J. Ries (eds.), *Publications de l'Institut Orientaliste de Louvain* 40, vol. 1 (Louvain-La-Neuve, 1992), 450-462; M. Rassart-Debergh and J. Ries, 'Leçons liturgiques au Monastère Blanc: Six Typika', *Bulletin de la Société d'Archéologie Copte* 46 (2007), 231-304; M. Rassart-Debergh and J. Ries, 'Leçons liturgiques au Monastère Blanc: Ancient Testament', *Bulletin de la Société d'Archéologie Copte* 46 (2007), 205-230.
 26. O.H.E. Burmester, *Le lectionnaire de la semaine sainte*, *Patrologia Orientalis* 24 fasc 2, 25 fasc 2 (Paris, 1933), 1943.
 27. D. Atanassova, 'Zu den sahidischen Pascha-Lektionaren', *Coptic Studies on the threshold of a new millennium*, in: M. Immerzeel, J. van der Vliet (eds.), *Coptic Studies on the Threshold of a New Millennium* (Leuven, 2004), 607-620.
 28. U. Zanetti, 'Les lectionnaires Coptes annuels Basse-Égypte', *Publications de l'Institut Orientaliste de Louvain* 33 (Louvain-La-Neuve, 1985), 39-40.
 29. Archdeacon Banûb Abdû *كنوز النعمة لمعونة خدام الكلمة في شرح أناجيل السنة التوتية حسب توتيب ومعتقد الكنيسة القبطية الأرثوذكسية، الجزء الرابع، الصوم المقدس*, [Treasures of grace for the helping of the ministers of the words in the explanations of the Gospels of the Cairo: nd], 96.
 30. O.H.E. Burmester, 'Le Lectionnaire de la Semaine Sainte texte Copte édité avec traduction française', *Patrologia Orientalis* 25 Fascicule 2, N° 122 (Paris, 1943), 475[427]-485[437].
 31. Athanasius bishop of Bani Souif, ΠΙΧΩΜΗ ἡΤΕ ΠΙΧΗΚΩΤ ἡΠΩΑΙ ἡΤΕ ΠΙCΤΑΥΡΟC ΠΕΝ ΦΑ ΠΩΑΙ ἡΤΕ ΠΙΒΑΙ ΠΕΝ ΠΙ΄ΑΛΙΑ ἡΤΕ ΠΙΖΗC ΕΘΥ ΠΕΝ ΠΑ ΠΙΠ ἡΕΖΟΟΥ ΕΘΥ ΚΑΤΑ ΤΤΑΞΙC ἡΤΕ ΤΕΚΚΑΗCΙΑ ΕΘΥ ἡΠΕΝ ἡΧΗΜ ἡΠΟΡΘΟΛΟΖΟC, [the book of the procession of the Feasts of the Cross and the Feast of the Palm (Sunday) and the psalis of the holy fortieth (days = lent) and the holy fiftieth days (the Eastertide) according to the rite of the holy Egyptian (Coptic) Orthodox Church], (Cairo, 1983), 113-114.
 32. Up to here in the Coptic text.
 33. Up to here in the Coptic text.
 34. Lit 'walked'.
 35. Ps. 55:22.
 36. G Viaud, 'La procession des deux fêtes de la Croix et du Dimanche des Rameaux dans l'Eglise Copte', *Bulletin de la Société d'Archéologie Copte* 19 (1967-1968), 211-226, especially 225.
 37. U. Zanetti, 'Liturgy in the White Monastery', *Christianity and Monasticism in Upper Egypt*, in: G. Gabra and H. Takla (eds.) (Cairo, New York, 2008), 201.